What a finished day looks like

Three headings, three paragraphs, about eighty words. This is one real day, written the way it should be.

Monday, 10 November

1 · THANK YOU FOR

Two sentences. One real thing, and why.

One thing I am grateful for today is that my mom let us play outside until the street lights came on. I am grateful because we got to finish the whole match and I scored the last goal.

2 · WHAT HAPPENED

Three sentences. First, then, after that. It happened yesterday, so: walked, not walk.

First, I woke up late and I had to run to get my bag ready. Then, at break, Thabo and I found a lizard under the water pipe and we watched it for a long time. After that, I came home and my hands were so dirty that Dad made me wash them twice.

3 · THE STORY

Three sentences. Made up is fine. Something must happen.

The night the moon went out. One night the moon just switched off like a lamp and everything went dark. My dog started howling and I was the only one who was not scared. We climbed the hill with a torch and found the little man whose job was to change the moon's bulb.

Before you close the book — four checks, out loud

1. Does it make sense when I read it back? **2.** Big letter at the start, full stop at the end of every sentence? **3.** Finger spaces between the words? **4.** Is there one word I could swap for a better one?

My journal

Date _____

1 · THANK YOU FOR

Two sentences. One real thing, and why.

2 · WHAT HAPPENED

Three sentences. First, then, after that.

3 · THE STORY

Three sentences. Made up is fine.

Four checks before you stop

1. Does it make sense when I read it back? **2.** Big letter, full stop? **3.** Finger spaces? **4.** One better word?

My Friday story

Date

Take the best story of the week and write it again, longer. Six to eight sentences. A beginning, a middle and an end.

TITLE

Two checks for the Friday story

1. Does the end know it is the end? **2.** Does the title make me want to read it?

This week's eight words

Week _____

MONDAY — WRITE THEM HERE

Copy the eight words from the week's list, or a grown-up writes them. Look, say it, cover it, write it, check it — three times each.

1 ×3

2 ×3

3 ×3

4 ×3

5 ×3

6 ×3

7 ×3

8 ×3

Five steps, five minutes

Look at the word and **say** it. **Cover** it. **Write** it from memory. **Uncover** and **check**. If it is wrong, do it once more and move on. Three wrong on Monday is normal; one on Thursday is normal.

FRIDAY — NO LOOKING

A grown-up says each word. Write it in the numbered slot. Whatever he gets right is what he got right — no mark, no score.

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8